

Cohen's Woe: ASU Not No. 1

Don't blame El Paso Diablo General Manager Jim Paul if he starts talking to himself this weekend. The first year office leader of E.P.'s Texas League baseball entry has just about seen the fancy paint job on Dudley Field's outfield walls completed . . . and now Western Athletic Conference baseball play begins!

And if Andy Cohen didn't have enough to worry about as far as his University of Texas at El Paso baseball team's WAC chances were concerned Arizona State is riding into town in a bad mood. An offensive mood to be exact.

With their best pre-WAC record (19-8) in years the Miners set to open conference play at 2 p.m. tomorrow at Dudley against ASU's "not No. 1 ranked" Sun Devils.

"We know they're going to be tough and we've got to hope we can slow them up a little," Miner coach Cohen commented. "We will need some steady pitching in the series, that's for sure." ASU can knock these fences down if they're hot."

FOR SURE, pitching has not been too steady for UTEP in 27 games. While Miner hitters are

currently ripping the ball right at the .300 level the UTEP pitching staff earned run average is over 3.00, over 4.00 and almost over 5.00.

"We know we'll score but I don't know whether we can outscore ASU if it becomes a slugfest," Andy reasoned.

Either righty Bob Know or northsider Dave Jannusch will open tomorrow with the odd man hurling one of Saturday's (1 p.m.) twinbill.

Currently ranked No. 1 in the nation, Arizona is the preseason WAC diamond favorite but ASU coach Jim Brock is not ready to end the Sun Devils three year reign of WAC titles.

Hard-working Pitcher

LOS ANGELES (UPI) — Don Drysdale was one of baseball's hardest working pitchers during his 14-year career with the Los Angeles and Brooklyn Dodgers.

Drysdale pitched almost 5,300 innings in 518 National League games prior to his retirement in 1969. He also was the last remaining active player in Los Angeles who had played with the Dodgers in Brooklyn.